AI Operator Weekly

Operating manual, for Mohil and whoever helps run it · November 2026 · runs on Mohil's Mac

> **The one rule:** nothing ever sends by itself. Every issue ends as a **draft**. Mohil reads it, edits it and presses send.

1. What it does, in one minute

1. **Every day** it reads about 15 AI news feeds (free) and has Claude find and score the day's important stories (about $0.30).
2. **Once a week** (Saturday, or the first day after it you're at the Mac) it picks the best 5 stories, has Claude check each one against the original sources and the vendors' own pricing pages, writes the full 13-section issue, then has a second, stricter Claude model fact-check it.
3. A **quality gate** in code blocks the issue if anything is unsourced, out of date, exaggerated or missing.
4. If it passes, the issue lands in **beehiiv as a draft**, and you get a "draft ready" alert.
5. **After you send**, it pulls opens and clicks back so later issues learn what readers liked.

2. When it runs

Not at fixed times, because a sleeping Mac would miss them. It starts the day's work once you have been **using the Mac for 30 minutes in a row** and **no meeting is on** (any microphone in use, or a Zoom meeting). Never before 6am. Each job runs once a day; the weekly issue once a week.

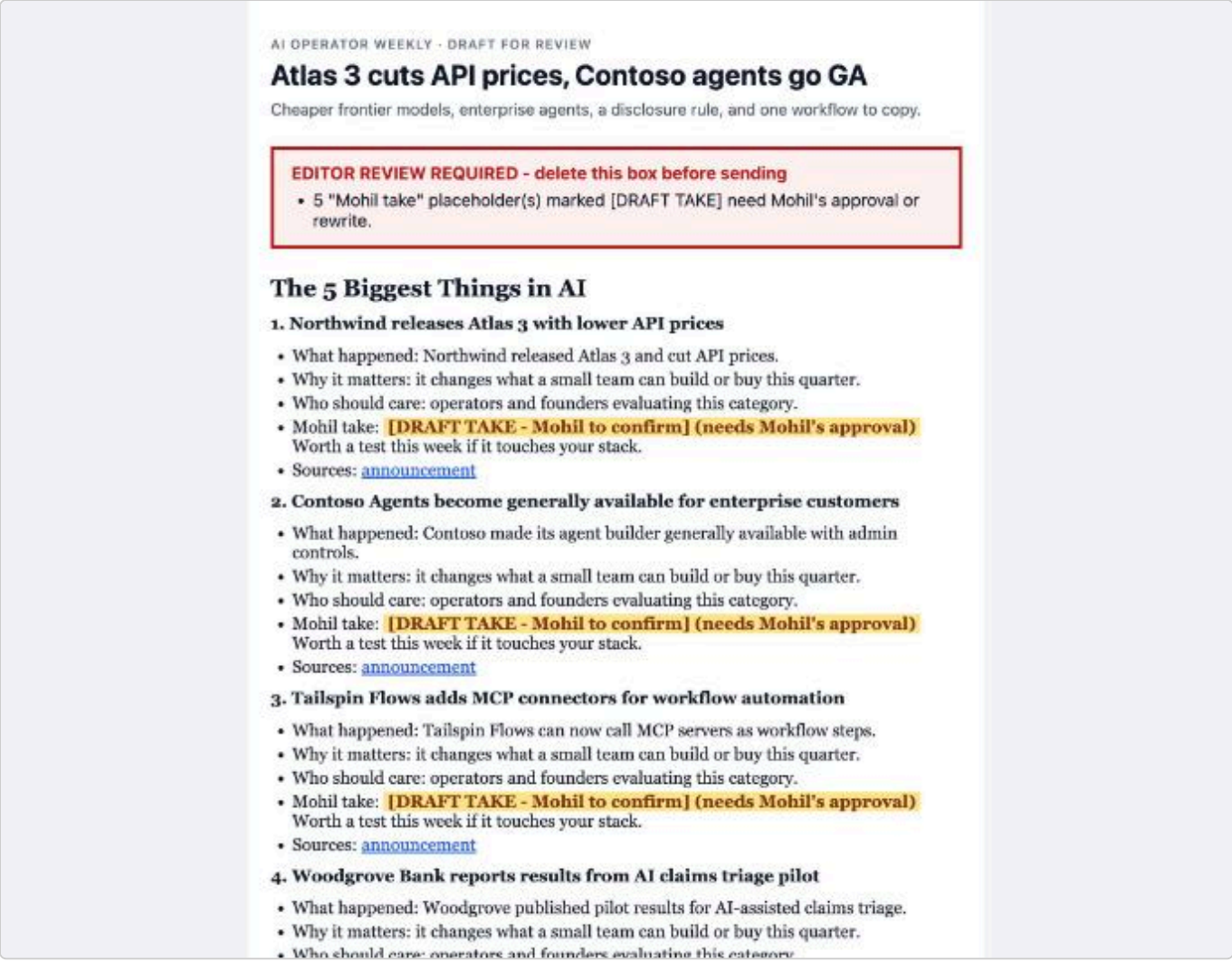
Job	What it does	Cost
Collect	Reads the news feeds into Airtable	Free
Daily scout	Claude finds and scores the day's stories	≈ $0.30
Weekly issue	Research → write → fact-check → gate → beehiiv draft	≈ $4–7
Analytics	Pulls beehiiv stats for sent issues	Free
Maintenance (Sundays)	Backup, Airtable clean-up, log rotation	Free

3. Your weekly routine

1. **Optional, before Saturday:** write your takes. Make a file `notes/<issue-date>.md` with a line per story, or type them into that week's row in Airtable → **Issues** → **mohil_notes**. Without them each

"Mohil take" shows as a highlighted *[DRAFT TAKE]* for you to fill in.

2. **When the "draft ready" alert arrives**, open the beehiiv draft (link in the alert). Until beehiiv is connected: open `out/<date>/preview.html` and paste `out/<date>/issue.html` into a new beehiiv post (see the manual fallback doc).
3. **Read the red "EDITOR REVIEW REQUIRED" box** at the top. It lists what needs your decision (takes to approve, length, anything flagged). Deal with each, then delete the box.
4. **Pick a subject line** from the options and send from beehiiv as usual.



AI OPERATOR WEEKLY · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

Atlas 3 cuts API prices, Contoso agents go GA

Cheaper frontier models, enterprise agents, a disclosure rule, and one workflow to copy.

EDITOR REVIEW REQUIRED - delete this box before sending

- 5 "Mohil take" placeholder(s) marked [DRAFT TAKE] need Mohil's approval or rewrite.

The 5 Biggest Things in AI

1. Northwind releases Atlas 3 with lower API prices

- What happened: Northwind released Atlas 3 and cut API prices.
- Why it matters: it changes what a small team can build or buy this quarter.
- Who should care: operators and founders evaluating this category.
- Mohil take: **[DRAFT TAKE - Mohil to confirm] (needs Mohil's approval)** Worth a test this week if it touches your stack.
- Sources: announcement

2. Contoso Agents become generally available for enterprise customers

- What happened: Contoso made its agent builder generally available with admin controls.
- Why it matters: it changes what a small team can build or buy this quarter.
- Who should care: operators and founders evaluating this category.
- Mohil take: **[DRAFT TAKE - Mohil to confirm] (needs Mohil's approval)** Worth a test this week if it touches your stack.
- Sources: announcement

3. Tailspin Flows adds MCP connectors for workflow automation

- What happened: Tailspin Flows can now call MCP servers as workflow steps.
- Why it matters: it changes what a small team can build or buy this quarter.
- Who should care: operators and founders evaluating this category.
- Mohil take: **[DRAFT TAKE - Mohil to confirm] (needs Mohil's approval)** Worth a test this week if it touches your stack.
- Sources: announcement

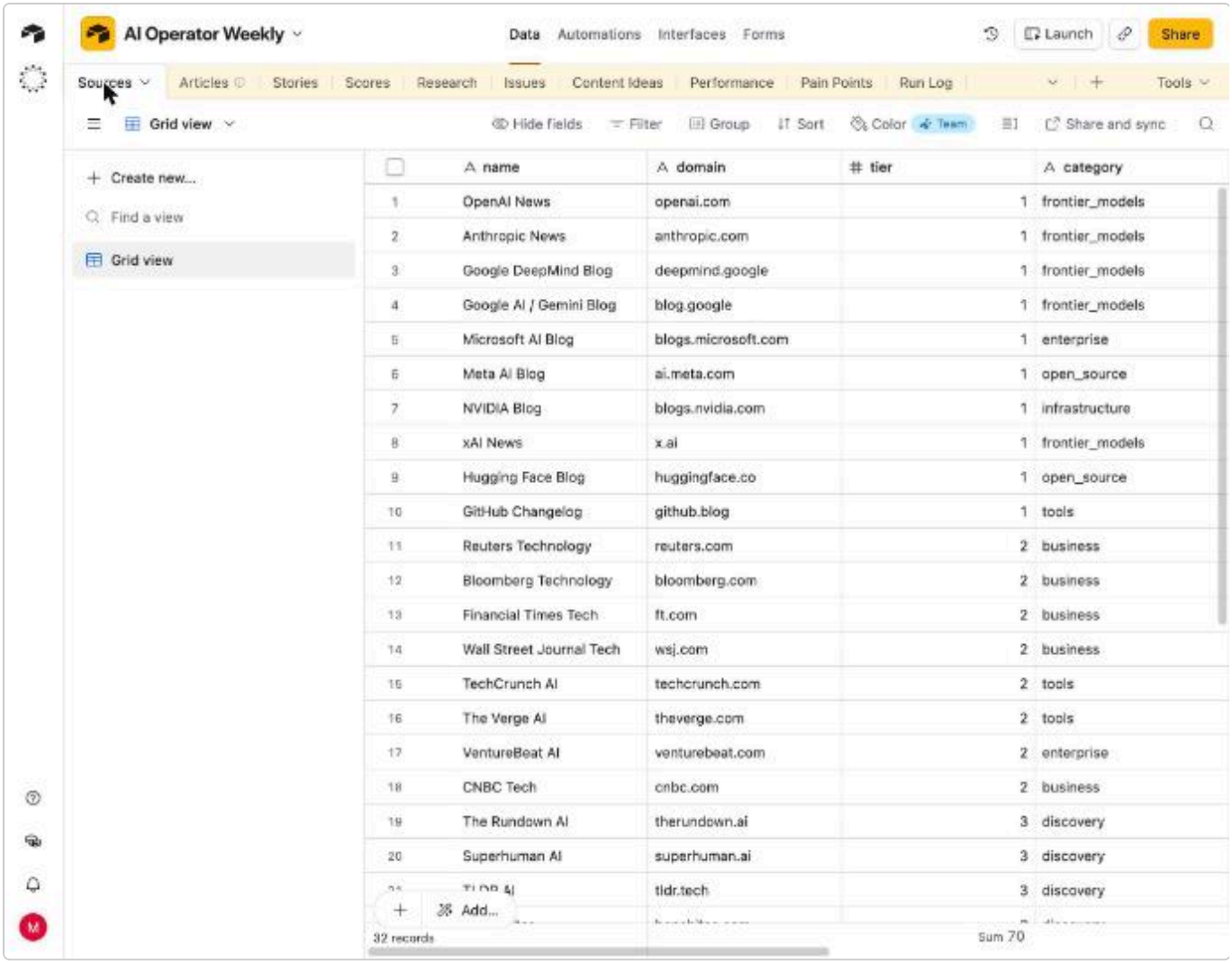
4. Woodgrove Bank reports results from AI claims triage pilot

- What happened: Woodgrove published pilot results for AI-assisted claims triage.
- Why it matters: it changes what a small team can build or buy this quarter.
- Who should care: operators and founders evaluating this category.

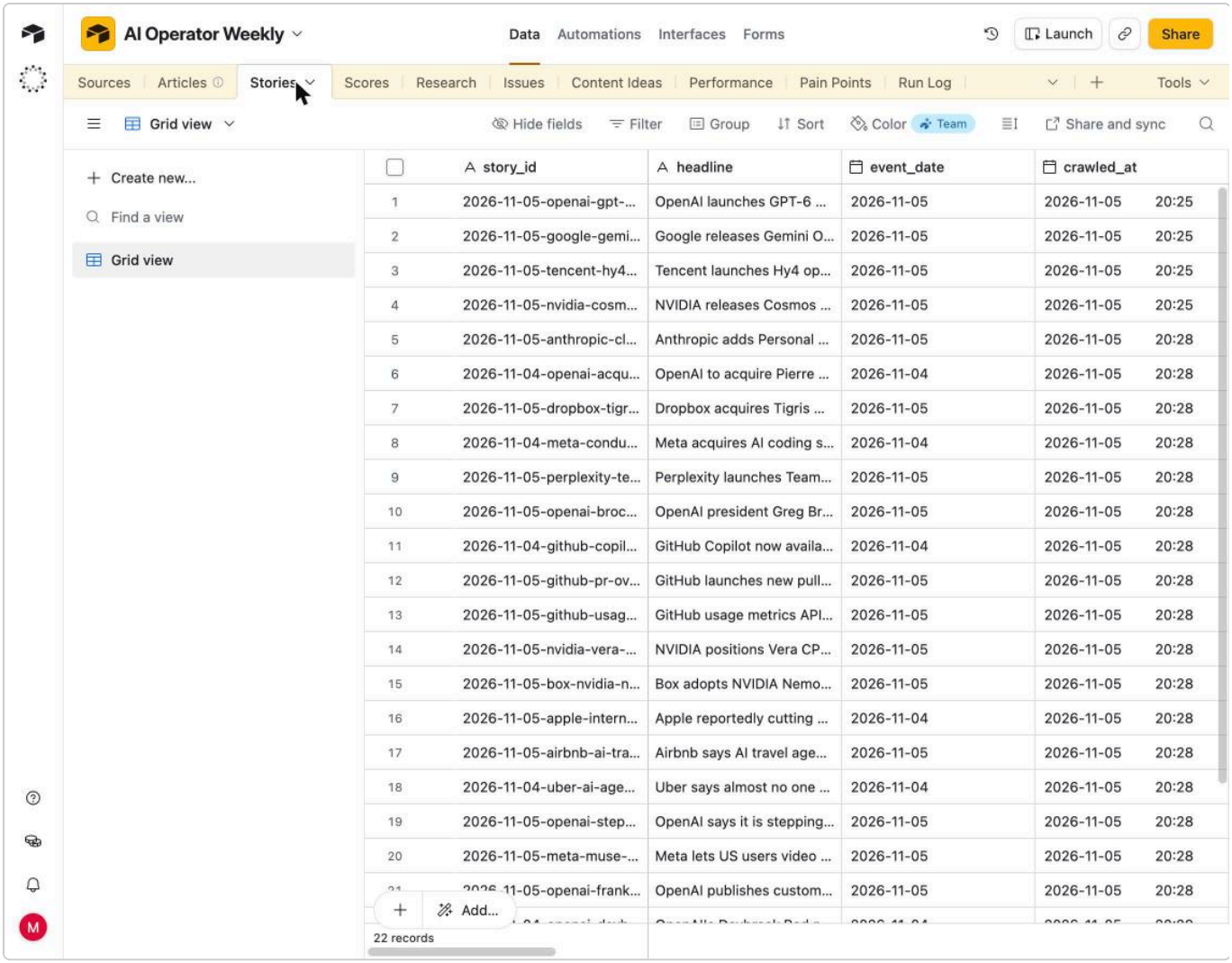
A generated draft (simulated test issue). The red box lists what needs your decision; highlighted [DRAFT TAKE]s are where your opinion goes.

4. Changing things

To change…	Do this
News sources	Airtable → **Sources**. Untick *active* to pause one; add a row to add one (tier 1 = official vendor, 2 = good reporting, 3 = newsletters, 4 = community)
Your takes	`notes/<date>.md` or Issues → *mohil_notes*
Which sections are required, word count, banned hype words	`config/newsletter.json`
How stories are ranked	`config/scoring.json` (importance 30%, usefulness 25%, business value 20%, novelty 15%, audience fit 10%)
What Claude is told	`prompts/*.md`
Spending cap	Claude Console → Spend limits → **Newsletter** workspace ($25/month now)



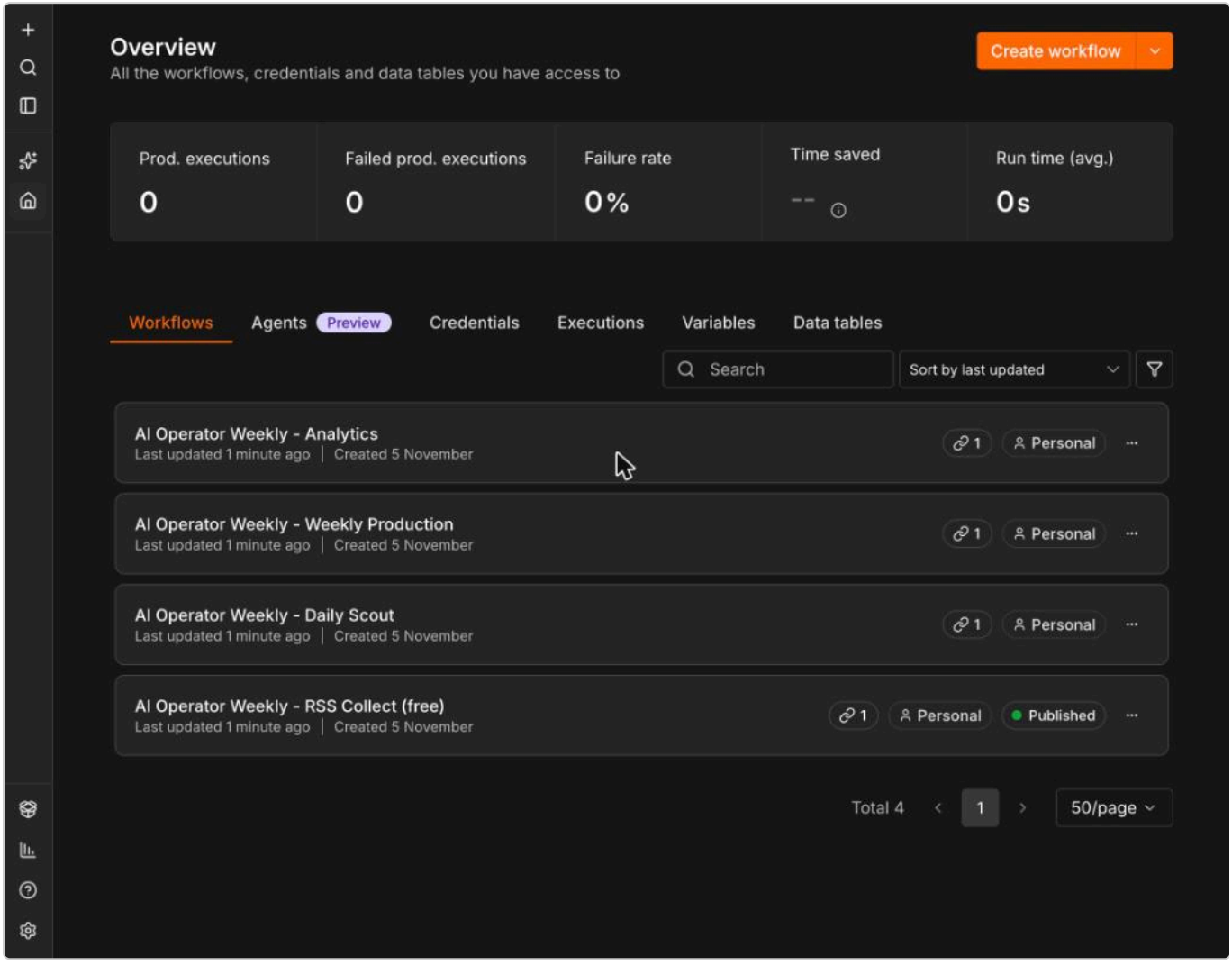
Airtable → Sources: the news sources and their trust tier. Edits here take effect on the next run.



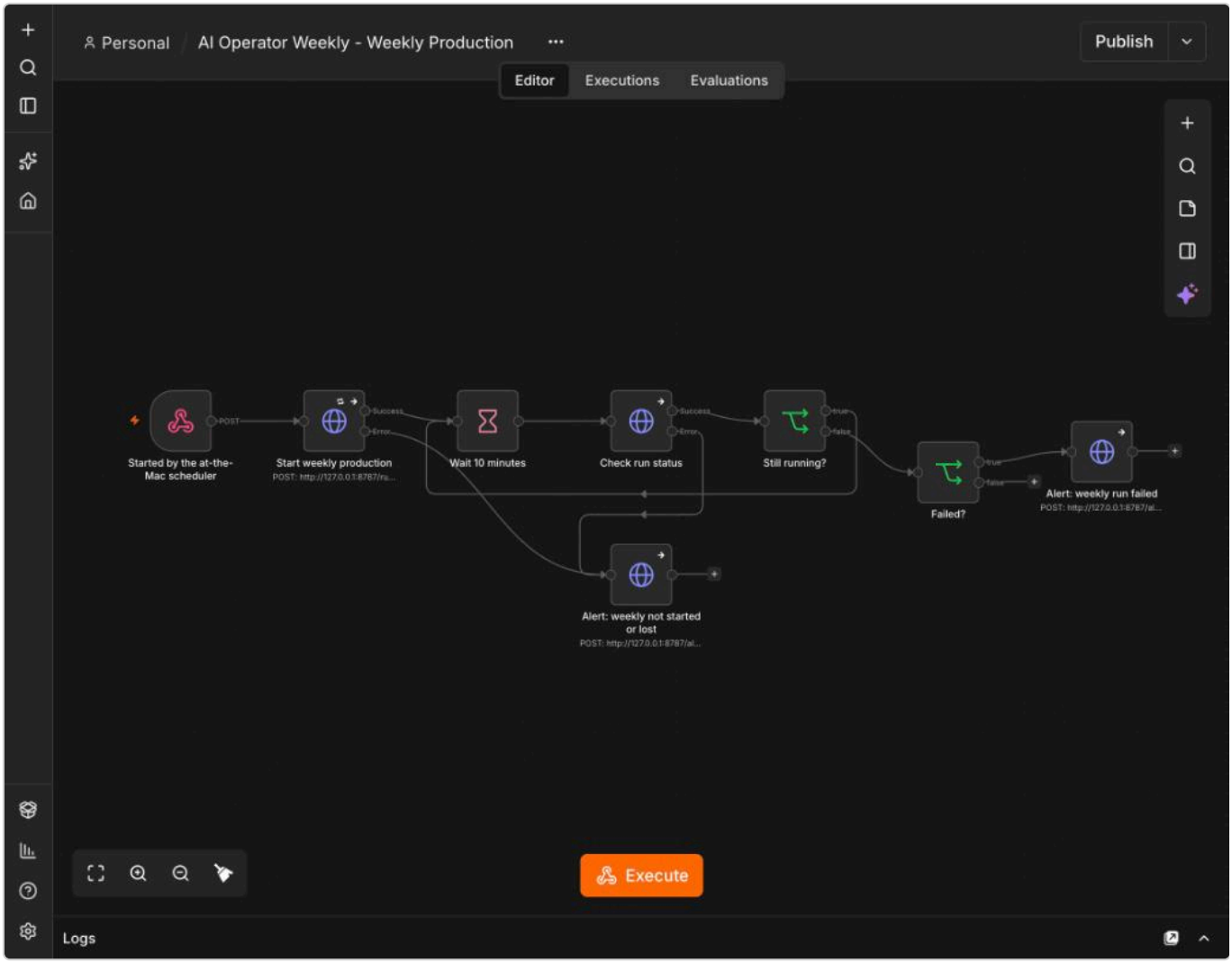
Airtable → Stories: every candidate story with its date and scores. The weekly issue picks from here.

5. The moving parts

Part	Where	Job
Pipeline	background service on this Mac	Does the actual work: feeds, Claude calls, gate, beehiiv draft, alerts
n8n	`http://localhost:5678` (login in `.env`)	Runs each workflow, waits for the weekly issue, alerts if it fails
Scheduler	checks every 5 minutes	Decides when you're at the Mac and free
Airtable	your "AI Operator Weekly" base	The database you can see and edit
Claude	Console, Newsletter workspace	Scout, researcher, writer, fact-checker
beehiiv	your publication	Receives drafts only



n8n: the four workflows. "Published" means switched on.



The weekly workflow: start the issue, check every 10 minutes, alert if it failed or was lost.

6. Alerts and what to do

You see	Means	Do
Draft ready for review	Issue passed every check	Review and send (section 3)
BLOCKED by the quality gate	A real problem: missing source, stale price, missing section	Read the listed reasons. Fix by hand, or ask for a rerun once fixed
Run failed	A service or Claude answer failed; the work so far is kept	Check `logs/aow.log`; see the manual fallback doc
RSS feeds failed	Half or more of the feeds are down	Usually temporary; pause bad ones in Airtable → Sources

Alerts arrive as a Mac notification now, and by email once the Gmail app password is added.

Health check and controls (Terminal)

Do	Type
Is everything running?	`~/Operator-Weekly-AI-work/repo/deploy/mac/setup.sh --status`
Turn the paid Claude steps ON	`~/Operator-Weekly-AI-work/repo/deploy/mac/setup.sh --paid`
Turn them OFF (free collection only)	`~/Operator-Weekly-AI-work/repo/deploy/mac/setup.sh`
Add or change a key/password (hidden typing)	`~/Operator-Weekly-AI-work/repo/deploy/mac/set-secrets.sh`

7. Status at handoff (brief, Appendix B)

Live = proven against the real service. **Simulated** = proven with fake services in the test suite, not yet live. **Not done**.

Item	Status	Evidence
Source registry created	**Live**	32 sources in Airtable; 15/15 feeds read on Nov 5 (2 bot-blocked feeds moved to web search)
Airtable schema built	**Live**	10 tables in Mohil's base
Daily Scout tested	**Live**	Nov 5: 18 stories saved, 0 rejected (after fixing a category bug)
Dedupe works	**Live + tests**	0 duplicates across repeated runs; duplicate test passes
Scoring rubric	**Live**	Scores table, weights in config
Deep research verifies primary sources	**Live**	Nov 5 run dropped evidence not from vendors' own pricing pages
Official pricing refresh	**Live + tests**	Pricing research ran live; stale-price test passes
Writer follows locked format	**Simulated**	Live writer answer was lost to a parsing bug, now fixed and tested; no live rerun (spending paused)
Fact-checker blocks unsupported claims	**Simulated**	Simulated run: blocked a false claim, passed after the fix
beehiiv draft creation	**Simulated**	Waiting for beehiiv sign-in
No publish/confirmed path	**Tests**	Draft-only payloads; send endpoints refused
Preview/post ID saved	**Simulated**	Saved in simulated run
Analytics pull	**Simulated**	Live run correctly skipped (no beehiiv yet)
Error alerts	**Live**	Mac notifications + n8n failure alert fired on Nov 5; email waits for app password
API/search budget logging	**Live**	Per-run estimates; $25 cap in the Console
README	**Done**	Includes "Running on Mohil's Mac"
Loom walkthrough	**Not done**	Needs a person to record; script in docs/WALKTHROUGH.md
Live draft reviewed by Mohil	**Not done**	Needs one live weekly run + beehiiv